



Using Coding Agents in Noteable with ELM® API Keys

Guidance for University of Edinburgh staff and students

AY 2026/27

Quick summary

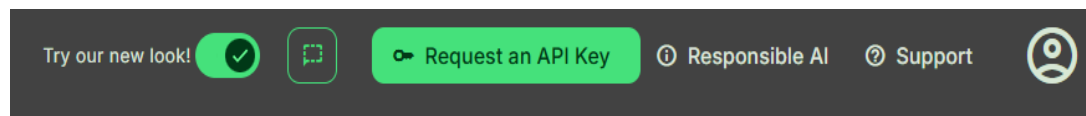
University staff and students can use AI coding agents in **Noteable** (the University's online coding platform).

Always check your course rules before using these tools for assessed work.

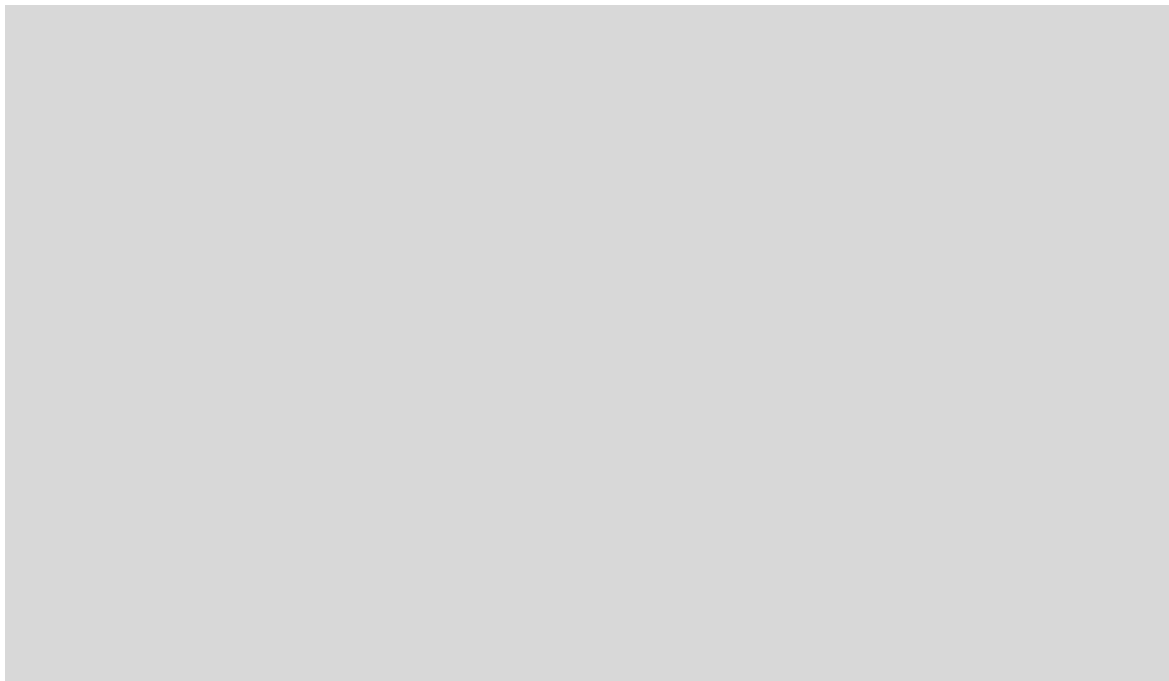
Getting started

To start, you must request an **API Key** from the ELM service and configure access to the ELM API key using Opencode in Noteable:

- Sign in to ELM (www.elm.edina.ac.uk) and select Request API key.



- Use your ELM API key in Opencode with the command **/connect**



Once you have an ELM API key, access Noteable and use the Terminal to connect using Opencode.

- **Check Permissions:** Some courses may disable these tools. Confirm with your lecturer if you are unsure.

Once the ELM API key is issued, you can configure the key to use coding agents through the Terminal in Noteable.

Keep your API key secure. Do not share it, upload it to notebooks or repositories, or include it in publicly accessible files.

ELM® API keys for teaching

Where a course requires students to use ELM® API keys, instructors should request a batch of individual student keys for the course.

Batch keys can be configured with appropriate:

- usage limits;
- model access;
- expiry dates.

Instructors are responsible for managing the course key request and ensuring keys are used appropriately. Students should not be asked to request ELM® API keys independently, as each individual request would require separate approval.

Important Rules & Safety

- **Assessments:** Do not use coding agents for assessed work unless permitted.
- **Declaration:** You must declare or acknowledge AI assistance where required.
- **Review Work:** You are responsible for all code produced. Check and test everything before using it.
- **Data Privacy:** Do not enter sensitive, confidential, or personal data into the AI.

What is a coding agent?

A **coding agent** is different from a standard chatbot.

- **Chatbot:** Answers questions in a chat window.
- **Coding Agent:** Works directly inside your Noteable workspace. It can read your files, suggest edits, debug errors, and run commands.

Tools available in Noteable (as of August 2026)

- Claude
- Codex
- OpenCode

Support

For help with Noteable access or technical issues, use the [Noteable contact form](#)

When reporting an issue, include the notebook environment, coding agent, command used, any error message, and steps to reproduce the problem.

Appendix: Technical Setup Details

How to Access Agents in Noteable

1. Launch your **JupyterLab** or **RStudio** environment in Noteable.
2. Open the **Terminal** (in JupyterLab) or **Terminal pane** (in RStudio).
3. Input your ELM API Key when prompted.

Video: setting up ELM API key in JupyterLab:



Common Commands

Type the following into the Terminal to start or get help:

- `claude --help`
- `codex --help`
- `opencode --help`
- `codex` (Starts the interactive session)

Video Guide

- [Setting up ELM API key in JupyterLab](#)

Glossary

- **API Key:** A unique code that acts like a password, allowing your Noteable workspace to securely access the ELM AI services.

- **Terminal:** A text-based interface where you type commands to control the computer environment.

- **Noteable:** A managed, secure online environment for writing and running code (Python, R, etc.).